



GRAND SLAM BRACKET CHALLENGE

Official Product Blueprint & Scoring Guide

Australian Open · French Open · Wimbledon · US Open

1. What Is the Grand Slam Bracket Challenge?

The Grand Slam Bracket Challenge lets participants predict match outcomes across all four of tennis's biggest tournaments — the Australian Open, French Open, Wimbledon, and the US Open — each year. Think of it as March Madness brackets, but built for tennis.

Each participant fills out one bracket per Slam (four per season). Points accumulate across the year, creating a single season-long leaderboard that builds drama from January through September.

Why Four Slams?

Each Slam is played on a different surface (hard, clay, grass, hard) — meaning different players dominate different events.

Running all four creates a season-long narrative, unique cross-tournament bonuses, and a richer, more competitive experience than any single-event bracket.

2. Tournament Structure

Every Grand Slam uses a 128-player, single-elimination main draw. To win the title, a player must win seven consecutive matches. Your bracket covers all seven rounds:

Rd	Round Name	Players In	Players Advance
1	Round of 128	128	64
2	Round of 64	64	32
3	Round of 32	32	16
4	Round of 16	16	8
5	Quarterfinals	8	4
6	Semifinals	4	2
7	The Final 🏆	2	1 Champion

Seeding — Key to the Bracket

Each Slam seeds the top 32 players based on world rankings.

The #1 and #2 seeds are placed on opposite halves — they cannot meet before the Final.

Seedings protect top players from facing each other in early rounds, keeping the best matchups for the later stages.

3. Scoring System

Points are earned for every correct pick. The further the round, the more each pick is worth. No points are ever deducted for wrong picks.

3a. Base Points (Per Correct Pick)

Each round doubles in value. This means the Final champion pick is worth 64× a first-round pick — keeping the competition alive deep into every Slam.

Rd	Round	Pts / Pick	Picks in Round	Max Pts
1	Round of 128	1	64	64
2	Round of 64	2	32	64
3	Round of 32	4	16	64
4	Round of 16	8	8	64
5	Quarterfinals	16	4	64
6	Semifinals	32	2	64
7	Final 🏆	64	1	64
	TOTAL PER SLAM		127	448
	SEASON TOTAL (4 Slams)		508	1,792 pts

3b. Upset Bonus

Correctly picking a lower-seeded player to beat a higher-seeded player earns a seed-disparity bonus on top of the base points. This rewards tennis knowledge and makes early-round picks genuinely exciting.

Upset Bonus Formula

Bonus Points = (Winner's Seed – Loser's Seed) × Round Multiplier

Round Multipliers: R1–R2 → ×1 R3–R4 → ×2 QF–SF → ×3 Final → ×5

Example: You pick the #12 seed to beat the #4 seed in the Semifinals.

Base points: 32 Upset Bonus: $(12 - 4) \times 3 = 24$ Total: 56 pts

Note: Unseeded players (seeds 33–128) use seed #33 for bonus calculations.

3c. Calendar Slam Bonus (The Season Meta-Game)

This is what makes the four-Slam format unique. If the same player wins multiple Slams in a calendar year and you correctly picked them to win each one, you earn a major bonus:

Achievement	Bonus Points
Same player wins 2 Slams — you picked both	+150 pts
Same player wins 3 Slams — you picked all 3	+400 pts
Same player wins all 4 — Calendar Grand Slam — you picked all 4	+1,000 pts 🌟

4. Season Leaderboard & Points Formula

Points accumulate across all four Slams in real time throughout the year. The season leaderboard is the main competitive ranking.

Season Score Formula

Season Score = AO Score + FO Score + Wimbledon Score + US Open Score + Calendar Slam Bonuses

Two award tiers keep the competition meaningful at every stage of the year:

Award	Description
Slam Champion (×4)	Top scorer for each individual Slam bracket
Season Champion (×1)	Highest cumulative season score across all four Slams

5. Tiebreaker Rules

If two or more participants finish with the same total, the following tiebreakers are applied in order:

Priority	Tiebreaker	How It Works
1st	Final Game Prediction	Closest prediction of total games played in each Slam Final
2nd	Final Sets Prediction	Closest prediction of total sets played in the Final
3rd	Semifinalist Accuracy	Who correctly predicted the most Semifinalists across all 4 Slams

6. Participation Rules & Fair Play

Bracket Submission

- Each participant submits one bracket per Slam — four per season total.
- Brackets lock automatically when the first match of each Slam begins. No edits after lock.
- All 127 picks in the main draw must be completed to submit a valid bracket.
- Tiebreaker predictions (games + sets in the Final) must be submitted at lock time.

Scoring Rules

- Points are awarded only for correct winner picks — no deductions for incorrect picks.
- Upset bonuses apply only when the higher-seeded player wins against a lower-seeded player.
- Calendar Slam Bonuses are calculated at the end of the tennis season (post US Open).
- If a player retires or withdraws mid-match, the winner of that match receives normal scoring.

Integrity

- One account per participant. Duplicate entries will be removed.
- Admin/operator accounts are ineligible for prizes.
- All scoring decisions by the platform are final.

7. Quick Reference Summary

Topic	At a Glance
Tournaments	4 Slams per season — AO, FO, Wimbledon, US Open
Main Draw	128 players, 7 rounds, single elimination
Picks Per Bracket	127 picks per Slam (all matches in the draw)
Base Scoring	1 → 2 → 4 → 8 → 16 → 32 → 64 pts (doubles each round)
Max Per Slam	448 base points
Season Max (base)	1,792 base points across all 4 Slams
Upset Bonus	(Winner Seed – Loser Seed) × Round Multiplier
Calendar Slam Bonus	+150 / +400 / +1,000 pts for 2 / 3 / 4-Slam prediction
Bracket Lock	Locks when the first match of each Slam begins
Tiebreaker	Final game count → Final set count → Most SFs correct

Design Philosophy

Every rule in this system is built around one goal: rewarding tennis knowledge while keeping everyone competitive deep into each Slam and across the full season.

The doubling point scale ensures the champion pick always matters. The upset bonus makes seeding knowledge valuable. And the Calendar Slam Bonus creates a unique season-long storyline that no single-event bracket can offer.